NOTE The source code repository accompanying this book contains additional instructions for setting up a Kubernetes cluster on a few different cloud platforms, in case you'd like to use something other than DigitalOcean.

There are two main options for interacting with the DigitalOcean platform. The first one is through the web portal (https://cloud.digitalocean.com), which is very convenient for exploring the available services and their features. The second option is via doctl, the DigitalOcean CLI. That's what we're going to use in the following sections.

You can find instructions for installing doctl on the official website (https://docs .digitalocean.com/reference/doctl/how-to/install). If you're on macOS or Linux, you can easily install it using Homebrew:

```
$ brew install doctl
```

You can follow the subsequent instructions on the same doctl page to generate an API token and grant doctl access to your DigitalOcean account.

NOTE In a real production scenario, you would automate the platform management tasks using a tool like Terraform or Crossplane. That is usually the responsibility of the platform team, not of application developers, so I won't add extra complexity here by introducing yet another tool. Instead we'll use the DigitalOcean CLI directly. If you're interested in Terraform, Manning has a book in its catalog on the subject: *Terraform in Action* by Scott Winkler (Manning, 2021; https://www.manning.com/books/terraform-in-action). For Crossplane, I recommend reading chapter 4 of *Continuous Delivery for Kubernetes* by Mauricio Salatino (https://livebook.manning.com/book/continuous-delivery-for-kubernetes/chapter-4).

B.1 Running a Kubernetes cluster on DigitalOcean

The first resource we need to create on DigitalOcean is a Kubernetes cluster. You could rely on the IaaS capabilities offered by the platform and install a